

The Daily Gamecock: Campus & Academics Ideas

Opinion Section

Spring 2026

Campus Facilities & Infrastructure

1. Campus Wi-Fi: An Eternal Enemy

- **Pro:** Note newly installed hotspots and improved IT support offering partial relief.
- **Con:** Slow, unreliable Wi-Fi disrupts learning and research with no fix in sight.
- **News Angle:** Overview of how campus Wi-Fi is managed plus official upgrade schedules.

2. Campus Infrastructure: Why Are Buildings Crumbling?

- **Pro:** Highlight major renovations or donor-funded projects aimed at updating older facilities.
- **Con:** Neglected maintenance stems from poor budget priorities and administrative oversight.
- **News Angle:** List of buildings slated for renovations with estimated timelines.

3. Study Space Shortfalls in Engineering

- **Pro:** Applaud new initiatives converting underused rooms into group study areas.
- **Con:** Administrators ignore student feedback, prioritizing other projects over study facilities.
- **News Angle:** Inventory of existing engineering study spaces with quotes from facility management.

4. Outdoor Study Spaces: Why the Engineering College Lacks Them

- **Pro:** Open-air study areas boost student well-being and collaborative creativity.
- **Con:** Ignored student suggestions highlight larger neglect of engineering needs.
- **News Angle:** Factual notes on existing outdoor spaces and proposals for new ones.

5. Vending Machines Need an Upgrade

- **Angle:** Machines need to be more reliable, offer better options, and have an easier way to report when broken.

6. Live Tracking System for Fitness Centers

- **Angle:** Can the live people-tracking system used in the library and Russell House be implemented at Strom and Blatt fitness centers?

7. A Nap Room for USC: The Unmet Need

- **Pro:** Designated rest spaces would boost productivity and overall student well-being.
- **Con:** A frivolous perk that distracts from real academic and administrative priorities.
- **News Angle:** Profile schools with nap rooms and compare usage data.

Transportation & Parking

1. Rethinking Parking: Why Getting a Spot Is So Tough

- **Pro:** Applaud new shuttle routes and pilot programs making campus more accessible.
- **Con:** Blame poor planning and insufficient investment for daily parking chaos.
- **News Angle:** Summary of parking regulations, available lots, and planned expansions.

2. Transportation Inequities: The True Cost of Getting to Class

- **Pro:** Praise ride-share partnerships or free shuttle routes easing commutes.
- **Con:** Inconsistent bus schedules and lack of accessible routes for students with disabilities.
- **News Angle:** Timetable of all campus transport options with official ridership data.

3. Why Doesn't USC Offer Free COMET Bus Service?

- **Angle:** Midlands Tech offers free bus service but USC doesn't—this works against students with less financial means.

4. Scooter vs. Pedestrian Safety

- **Pro:** Electric scooters should be allowed on campus for convenience.
- **Con:** Safety concerns between scooters and pedestrians need to be addressed first.

5. Game Day Uber Fiasco

- **Angle:** The chaos of trying to get an Uber or Lyft on game days—surge pricing, long waits, and safety concerns.

Housing & Development

1. Housing Market Madness: SC's Rising Costs

- **Pro:** Celebrate new student apartment complexes and variety of housing options.
- **Con:** High rents force students into financial strain or subpar living conditions.
- **News Angle:** Comparative pricing data with statements from property management.

2. Student Housing Crisis

- **Angle:** Deteriorating conditions of apartments and dorms; accessible apartments are expensive.

3. Greek Village Expansion vs. Sports Clubs

- **Angle:** USC's plan to buy land for Greek Village expansion, combined with Williams-Brice expansion, reduces available field areas for sports clubs.

4. On-Campus to Off-Campus Transition

- **Angle:** The challenges and tips for students transitioning from dorm life to off-campus living.

Dining & Campus Services

1. Dining Dollars: A Fast-Disappearing Resource

- **Pro:** Dining Dollars encourage students to try different on-campus eateries.
- **Con:** Hidden fees and limited partner options make them a poor bargain.
- **News Angle:** How Dining Dollars work, where accepted, and official usage policies.

2. Starbucks Hype: Why Is It Always Packed?

- **Pro:** Inviting atmosphere fosters social interaction and study sessions.

- **Con:** An overpriced status symbol for students who want to be seen.
- **News Angle:** Average wait times, locations on campus, and sales statistics.

3. Supporting Small Businesses in Columbia

- **Angle:** Highlight local restaurants and businesses that deserve more student attention.

4. GrubHub Robots on Campus

- **Angle:** Are the delivery robots helpful or just in the way? How do they impact campus life?

5. Campus Food Pantry Awareness

- **Angle:** Many students don't know about the food pantry—how can we increase awareness?

Academics & Registration

1. Reevaluating Academic Advising at USC

- **Pro:** Credit new initiatives bringing personalized guidance and better online scheduling tools.
- **Con:** System is understaffed, impersonal, and confusing during peak times.
- **News Angle:** Outline advising process and upcoming improvements under review.

2. The Textbook Price Problem

- **Pro:** Celebrate rise of digital and open-source materials as cost-effective alternatives.
- **Con:** Publishers and campus bookstores exploit captive markets, driving up prices.
- **News Angle:** Average textbook costs, new bookstore policies, and faculty statements.

3. Untangling Financial Aid Complexities

- **Pro:** Praise variety of scholarships, grants, and federal programs available.
- **Con:** Maze of paperwork and slow response times leave some students without timely support.
- **News Angle:** Core financial aid resources, important deadlines, and contact info.

4. Scheduling Strains: Senior Classes Scattered Across Campus

- **Pro:** Distance between classes is an opportunity for exercise and exploring campus.
- **Con:** Poor scheduling wastes students' time and increases stress.
- **News Angle:** Official explanations of scheduling algorithm and potential changes.

5. Night Classes: Why So Few Options?

- **Pro:** Expanded evening courses help working students and diversify class times.
- **Con:** Potential safety concerns and staffing challenges limit availability.
- **News Angle:** List of existing night classes with enrollment data and faculty perspectives.

6. First-Year Seminars: Building Foundations or Wasting Time?

- **Pro:** They equip freshmen with essential skills and ease the transition into college life.
- **Con:** Filler courses failing to provide meaningful academic or social engagement.
- **News Angle:** Data on retention rates, overall costs, and average student feedback.

7. Revisiting Blackboard: An Outdated Platform?

- **Pro:** A stable, widely recognized tool familiar to students and instructors.
- **Con:** Time for a switch to newer systems with more modern, user-friendly interfaces.
- **News Angle:** University's contract and technical support resources.

8. Stagnant Classroom Tech: Is USC Falling Behind?

- **Pro:** Simpler technology is reliable; caution against rapid, expensive overhauls.
- **Con:** Outdated projectors and seating are detrimental to modern educational experiences.
- **News Angle:** Official tech-upgrade plans with feedback from professors and IT staff.

9. The Hidden Curriculum: Skills Missing from Coursework

- **Pro:** Advocate for more life-skills lessons embedded in existing classes.
- **Con:** These topics should be learned independently, not forced into limited class time.
- **News Angle:** Survey results on essential “real-world” skills missing in curricula.

10. Group Projects: The Unseen Financial and Emotional Costs

- **Pro:** They foster teamwork, communication skills, and real-world collaboration.
- **Con:** Uneven workloads and scheduling hassles make them a frustrating academic tool.
- **News Angle:** Survey data comparing group-based vs. individual assignments.

Tuition & University Finances

1. Demystifying Tuition: Where Does the Money Go?

- **Pro:** Tuition funds essential improvements—new facilities, research expansions.
- **Con:** Lackluster transparency and misplaced spending priorities.
- **News Angle:** Official budget breakdowns and quotes from finance office.

2. In-State vs. Out-of-State Tuition Debate

- **Angle:** Should out-of-state students get in-state tuition? What are the trade-offs?

3. Top 10% Automatic Admission Policy

- **Pro:** Rewards hard work and ensures access for high achievers statewide.
- **Con:** Doesn’t account for differences in school quality and resources.

4. Unraveling Student Organization Funding

- **Pro:** Commend the university for allocating resources to diverse student groups.
- **Con:** Funding process is overly bureaucratic and unfairly distributed.
- **News Angle:** Step-by-step funding application process with official statements.

Research & Innovation

1. Research for Every Student: Exploring Untapped Potential

- **Pro:** Highlight benefits of hands-on research—personal growth and career readiness.
- **Con:** Research programs are time-consuming and inaccessible to students with limited resources.
- **News Angle:** Overview of research opportunities with deadlines and application processes.

2. Barriers to Undergraduate Research

- **Pro:** New mentorship programs could lower barriers and diversify participation.
- **Con:** Research is gatekept by elite faculty labs, making it inaccessible to the majority.
- **News Angle:** Open research positions across departments and application processes.

3. Spotlight on Innovation: Exciting Research Projects at USC

- **Pro:** Celebrate breakthroughs and potential real-world impacts of cutting-edge research.

- **Con:** Possible disconnect between lab findings and actual community benefit.
- **News Angle:** List specific projects and lab initiatives with progress updates.

4. Local AI on Campus: The Next Technological Frontier

- **Pro:** Celebrate local AI initiatives as revolutionary tools empowering students and faculty.
- **Con:** AI may increase data privacy concerns and potentially replace human-led research.
- **News Angle:** Basic facts about AI labs, upcoming events, and administrator quotes.

5. Engineering College Troubles: Searching for Solutions

- **Pro:** Point to recent renovations and initiatives improving labs and academic support.
- **Con:** Chronic underfunding and outdated infrastructure leave students ill-prepared.
- **News Angle:** Announced improvements and statements from college officials.

6. Clemson vs. USC in STEM: Bridging the Ranking Gap

- **Pro:** Collaborative research and statewide initiatives can raise USC's standing.
- **Con:** USC's structural issues in STEM are too deep-seated for quick fixes.
- **News Angle:** Comparative data on research funding, ratios, and national rankings.

Athletics & Game Day

1. Williams-Brice Stadium Expansion

- **Pro:** Expansion shows commitment to athletics and brings in more revenue.
- **Con:** Sports clubs are losing field areas due to expansion.
- **News Angle:** Details on the expansion plans and impact on other facilities.

2. Why Do We Have So Many Noon Games?

- **Angle:** Game days should be held in the afternoons for better attendance and atmosphere.

3. Dawn Staley's Contract and Women's Sports

- **Angle:** What does her contract say about how USC values women's sports?

4. USC Pride in Sports: Where's the School Spirit Off the Field?

- **Pro:** Vibrant game-day culture should expand that energy to other events.
- **Con:** Overemphasis on athletics drains attention from academic and cultural pursuits.
- **News Angle:** Attendance stats for both sports and non-sport events.

5. Trash on the Bleachers After Games

- **Angle:** How much trash is left behind? ROTC cadets clean it up—is that fair?

6. Alcohol in the Stadium

- **Pro:** Revenue generator and enhances the game-day experience for adults.
- **Con:** Safety concerns and impact on student behavior.

7. Clemson vs. USC: Which School Is Better?

- **Angle:** A head-to-head comparison—academics, athletics, campus life, and culture.

Campus Safety & Security

1. Crime on and Around Campus

- **Angle:** Do students feel safe? What is campus police doing about it?

2. Off-Campus Safety Concerns

- **Angle:** Do students feel safe living off-campus? Can they afford to live safely?

3. Frat Lot Safety Concerns

- **Angle:** Reports of incidents, distance from main campus, aggressive security interactions.

4. USC's Communication About Student Safety

- **Angle:** Critique of USC's poor communication with students regarding safety issues.

University Leadership & Policy

1. Revamped Student Leadership: Advocating for Real Change

- **Pro:** New student leadership teams have brought fresh perspectives and transparent communication.
- **Con:** Student leaders remain detached from the student body, offering little more than campaign promises.
- **News Angle:** Factual updates on recently enacted student government policies.

2. Do Student Organizations Feel Unheard by USC?

- **Pro:** Newly formed advisory boards facilitate constant communication with student groups.
- **Con:** Ongoing discontent stems from the university's slow response to urgent needs.
- **News Angle:** Timeline of recent policy decisions affecting organizations.

3. Reading the Future: Breaking Down USC's Master Plan

- **Pro:** Plan paves a path for modernizing campus, improving sustainability, adding resources.
- **Con:** Many proposed changes remain lofty promises with little concrete funding.
- **News Angle:** Key points from official master plan documents with projected dates.

4. How the University Handles Its Own History

- **Angle:** An editorial on how USC addresses its own history and state history.

5. Faculty Retention Issues: Why Professors Leave USC

- **Pro:** Highlight new faculty benefits or incentives to retain high-quality educators.
- **Con:** Low salaries, high workload, and limited support drive professors away.
- **News Angle:** Data on turnover rates and official faculty retention strategies.